



PERSONAL REFLECTION

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REFLECTION REPORT

Looking back on my second semester of the second year, I can honestly say this has been the semester where I grew the most, not just as a developer, but as a person and as a professional / team member. This reflection report will cover my Personal Development goals, the feedback I have received and gave, and how everything connects back to patterns I identified in my previous semester.

At the start of this semester I came in with a cleared head than semester one. I had already learned the hard way in period one of my second year that poor sleep and poor planning would cost me, and I carried that lesson into this semester. My PDP (Personal Development Plan) this time were more focused on my technical development, because I know that I need to prove myself by work and not only knowledge for my future internship employers.

My first goal was to deploy a production ready full stack web application. This goal was person for me because I always built projects like this, never finished them, and definitely never deployed them. In my internship portfolio they were all going to be just GitHub links and screenshots, so I set out to build a full stack ecommerce website using React and Nestjs, containerized in Docker. I also set up a GitHub actions pipeline that Lints, type checks and runs tests against a real Postgres instance and automatically deploys to the deployed website if everything was successful of course. To be honest, seeing all my tests passing in the end, and a live deployed website updating with my changes really made me excited about development. I went through the full software development life cycle, and I know feel like a better developer than I was before.

My second goal was combined with my first goal. I built and integrated a mini AI chatbot into my website, but not the kind that checks for a keyword in the text. I created a syste, that could understand the meaning behind a user's message and determine what they were trying to do. This was done by using the Naïve Bayes method, where it basically cleans the text and extracts the words and makes associations based on its training with the extracted words to figure out the user's intent. As a result, developing this feature has helped me gain a better understanding of how machine learning works in practice. It also improved my backend development skills, as I had to ensure the chatbot worked with my backend.

My third goal was to learn how to make iOS applications using SwiftUI and do something from web development. I wanted to see what it was like to build something for a phone. For this goal I made a task management application. This application was not very complicated I just wanted to learn about the parts that users interact with and how to put them together using SwiftUI. I learned a lot from this project like how SwiftUI helps you move from one screen to another how it remembers what you did and how it saves your information. I also learned what it is like to work in a new environment, which is very different from web development. This helped me understand how mobile applications are put together and designed. Even though my application was not very

complex it taught me a lot about making iOS applications. Showed that I can learn new things outside of what I normally do. By the time I finished the project I was good at making interfaces with SwiftUI. I understood a lot more, about how iOS applications are made. I was happy that I could make something for a phone using SwiftUI.

When it comes to the group project this semester I saw a difference between the two periods. In period three I really cared about the project. I took charge. Helped the team make technical decisions. I also made sure the project was going in the direction. I was the one who always spoke up in client meetings. I asked questions gave ideas and made sure my teammates were doing okay. If I look back at what I wrote about myself in semester one I said I was the one who just did what I was told and did not say much. Period three was totally different from that. My lecturer Martijn said some things, about me and that shows how much I have grown. I am talking about the group project when I say this. The group project was where I saw this change in myself.

On the other hand, period 4 has been different, I still contributed ideas and voiced my opinions, but I was less driven, and the honest reason is that I did not like this project too much. I could feel myself pulling back in the same way I used to in semester one, but luckily not as much as I used to, which did and does show that I at least have grown and improved this bad characteristic of myself.

The feedback I received from my peers this period was positive and showed a consistent pattern. They saw me as a strong technical contributor who delivered quality work and takes on challenging tasks, and skilled in development. At the same time, they also highlighted communication as an area for improvement, stating that I can sometimes come across as too direct or confrontational, as well as spending more time thinking about software architecture rather than focusing on getting a solution working. Reflecting on this feedback I do agree with these points and have identified these as the two new areas of improvement which I will continue to develop.

Looking back on the year, I feel that I have improved a lot, both as a developer and a team member. This year has proved that I can take initiative when needed, step into a leadership role within a group, and see projections through till the end. During the year I improved my technical skills especially in the backend department, but by creating full stack web applications, machine learning and app/iOS development, also learning about myself through feedback from teachers and my teammates. At the same time, I became aware of areas I still need to work on, particularly my communication and software design skills. Overall this year has given me a confidence boost in my abilities and show that I can achieve much more than I thought initially.